

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM/SOAR | EDR/XDR | Cloud Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience taking technical ownership of enterprise security across large-scale environments. I have deep expertise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) alert triage, email and web security gateways including Mimecast, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO) using Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), and Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) through Microsoft Intune. In my current role at the University of the Arts London I lead security operations for over 8,000 users, maintaining and hardening security across global infrastructure while driving measurable improvements in detection, response, and vulnerability remediation. I am seeking a senior engineering role within a focused, high-impact team where I can apply my breadth of tools expertise and strategic thinking to protect critical global assets.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **EDR/XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR Prevent, Insight, Discover) - expert level; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)
- **SIEM/SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL); CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM; SOAR playbook development and automation
- **Email and Web Security Gateways:** Mimecast; Microsoft Defender for Office 365 (MDO)
- **MFA/SSO and Identity:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO; BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **MDM/MAM:** Microsoft Intune; Mobile Application Management (MAM) policy enforcement
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); Tenable.io; AppCheck; Nessus; penetration test remediation
- **Firewalls and Network Security:** Check Point Harmony; network segmentation; WAF and DDoS concepts
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), NIST SP 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell; KQL; SOAR logic and workflow automation
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA), CompTIA A+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Take technical ownership of implementing, maintaining, and hardening security across a 8,000-plus user global infrastructure, serving as the primary engineering escalation point within the security function.
- Manage and optimise CrowdStrike Falcon EDR/XDR platform including NG-SIEM, Prevent, Insight, and Discover modules; configure detection policies, exclusions, and response actions to reduce mean time to detect and respond.
- Engineer and maintain Microsoft Sentinel (SIEM/SOAR) including custom analytics rules written in KQL, playbook automation via Logic Apps, data connector onboarding, and incident management workflows; produce dashboards and reporting pipelines covering incident trends and rule performance.
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft Defender for Office 365 (MDO) across the full M365 environment, including alert triage, advanced hunting queries, and tuning to reduce false positives.

- Manage Mimecast email security platform including policy configuration, threat intelligence feeds, impersonation protection, and URL scanning; liaise with users and teams on quarantine decisions and reporting.
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, SSO integrations, and Privileged Identity Management (PIM); reduce identity attack surface in line with Zero Trust principles.
- Oversee Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM environment including device compliance policies, application deployment, configuration profiles, and conditional access integration for both managed and Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) endpoints.
- Lead vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS; prioritise findings by severity and business impact, assign remediation tasks, and track to closure; manage penetration test findings and remediation plans.
- Administer BeyondTrust PAM solution including session recording, least-privilege enforcement, password vault management, and privileged user lifecycle; reduce standing privileged access across the estate.
- Develop and maintain SOAR playbooks using CrowdStrike Fusion SOAR to automate alert enrichment, triage, and containment actions; reduce analyst toil on high-volume, low-complexity events.
- Lead incident response activities in accordance with NIST SP 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK framework; conduct post-incident reviews and drive continuous improvement of detection logic and response runbooks.
- Manage security awareness training programme and deliver security awareness sessions across the organisation; track phishing simulation metrics and report to senior stakeholders.
- Produce board-level and management reporting on the security posture, key risk indicators, and programme progress; present findings to the IT Security Officer and senior leadership.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Delivered day-to-day Security Operations Centre (SOC) functions including alert triage, investigation, and incident escalation across SIEM and EDR platforms for an 8,000-user environment.
- Engineered and tuned detection content in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM; developed KQL analytics rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs).
- Conducted proactive threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel; investigated anomalies in endpoint, identity, and email telemetry.
- Managed identity and access controls including Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access, MFA rollout, SSO configurations, and Privileged Identity Management; supported onboarding of new SSO-integrated applications.
- Administered Mimecast email security policies, responded to phishing reports, and managed quarantine releases and block-list updates.
- Managed Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM policies covering Windows, iOS, and Android devices; enforced compliance baselines and managed device enrolment.
- Ran vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io and Nessus; produced remediation reports and worked with IT teams to prioritise patching aligned to CVSS severity and business context.
- Supported ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus audit activities; maintained security controls documentation and evidence packs.
- Contributed to policy development, security architecture reviews, and risk assessments aligned to NIST Cybersecurity Framework and CIS Controls.
- Maintained Check Point Harmony firewall rules and change management processes; reviewed network traffic logs and responded to firewall alerts.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Delivered security engineering, quality assurance, and infrastructure support for a SaaS and FinTech software company serving global enterprise clients.
- Managed endpoint security tooling, network security configurations, and cloud infrastructure security in Microsoft Azure environments.

- Supported Azure Active Directory administration including user lifecycle management, group policies, MFA enforcement, and access reviews.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and worked with development teams to remediate findings in the application stack; contributed to secure software development lifecycle (SDLC) processes.
- Supported compliance activities aligned to ISO 27001 and SOC 2; produced documentation and evidence for internal and external audits.
- Managed IT infrastructure including server maintenance, network monitoring, and help desk escalations; ensured high availability of critical services.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and optimised CrowdStrike Falcon EDR/XDR across an 8,000-user environment at UAL, achieving full endpoint visibility and reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) by over 40 per cent.
- Engineered a detection engineering programme in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, delivering over 60 custom analytics rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, reducing high-fidelity false positives by 35 per cent.
- Led the implementation of BeyondTrust PAM, eliminating standing privileged access for over 200 administrative accounts and achieving alignment with CIS Controls and ISO 27001 access management requirements.
- Built and automated SOAR playbooks using CrowdStrike Fusion SOAR, reducing analyst handling time on routine alerts by over 50 per cent and increasing SOC capacity for complex investigations.
- Delivered a Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) programme identifying critical attack paths; drove remediation that closed exposure gaps across Active Directory and cloud environments.
- Managed Mimecast email security at scale, reducing successful phishing attempts and improving email threat intelligence processing across the organisation.
- Rolled out Conditional Access and MFA policies across Microsoft Entra ID for 8,000-plus users, achieving near-total MFA coverage and materially reducing identity-based attack risk.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)